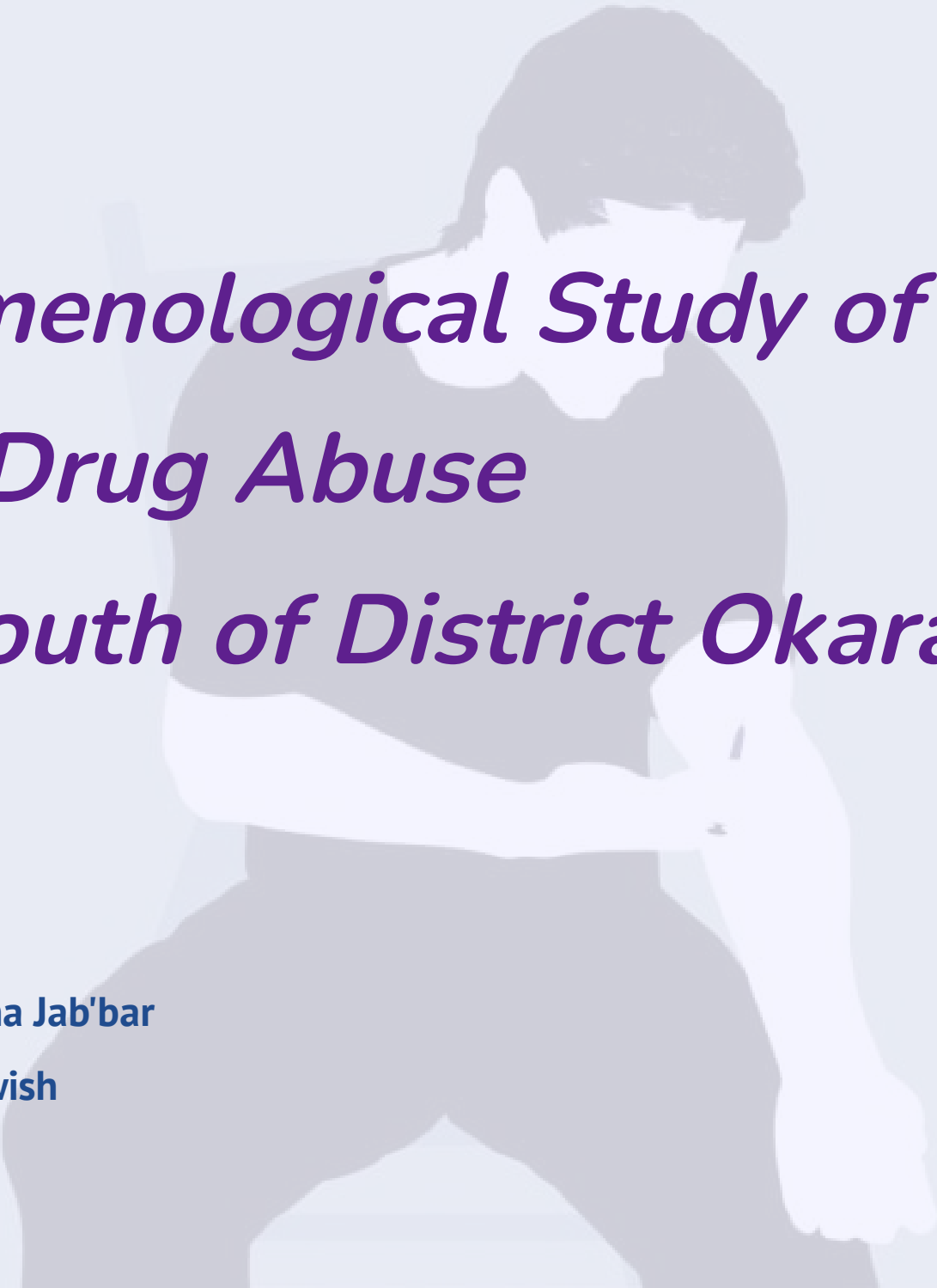




Department of Psychology, University of Okara



A Phenomenological Study of Injection Drug Abuse Among Youth of District Okara

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Introduction

Injection drug abuse is defined as a maladaptive pattern of substance use leading to clinically significant impairment or distress, occurring any time in the same 12-month period.

Injecting drug use (IDU) is associated with a range of harms that are specific to injection as a route of drug administration. One major form of physical harm is the transmission of blood-borne viruses, such as hepatitis C virus (HCV) and HIV.

Addiction is defined as a maladaptive pattern of substance use leading to clinically significant impairment or distress, occurring any time in the same 12-month period.

Psychosocial factors like loneliness, parental coldness and peer pressure are major contributors to addiction. Curiosity to try new things is one of the most common reasons reported by drug users themselves. Family ties have an important role in the recovery process from addiction. Family support and concern for one's own health are the most important motivating factors for quitting abuse, whereas socializing with the same peer groups and easy availability of drugs are the biggest reasons for relapse. It is manifested by tolerance, withdrawal and other symptoms.

If children initiate drug or alcohol abuse at age 10–11 years, there is a greater chance that they will be trapped in addiction at age 17–18 years

Approximately 15.9 million people inject drugs worldwide, with the largest numbers found in China, America and Russia. Annual prevalence of all illicit drug use in Pakistan was reported as 6% in 2013. The highest number of intravenous drug abusers among all provinces is in Punjab, which includes a high ratio of polydrug abuse among addicts in Lahore using heroin and opium together.

Objectives

To identify the various risk factors associated with injection Drug use among youth in district Okara

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To explore and understand the lived experiences of youth who engage in injection Drug use in District Okara

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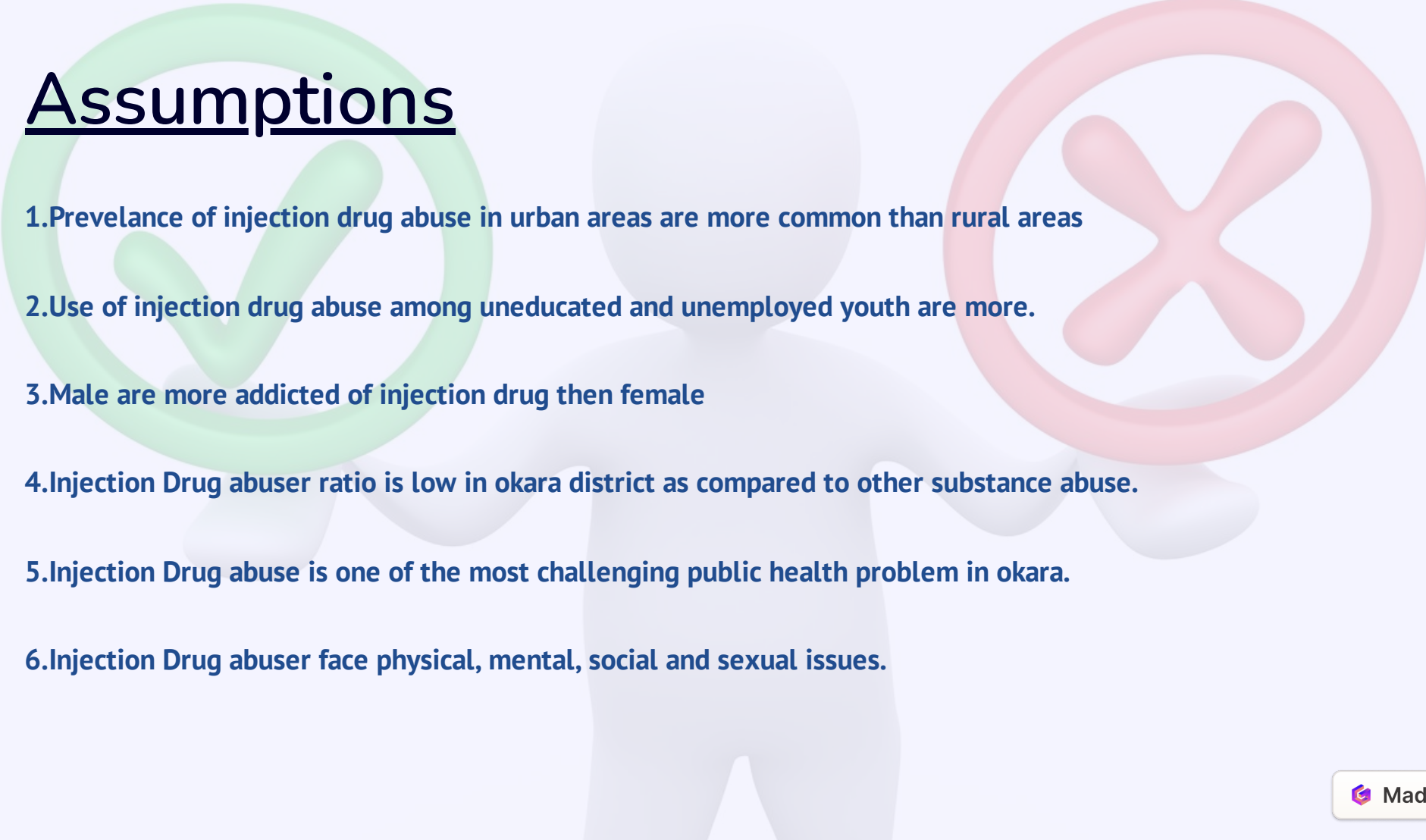
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To investigate the health implications of injection Drug use among youth in district Okara

Research Questions

1. What are the lived experiences of youth engaging in injection Drug use in district Okara?
2. How do youth describe motivations and reasons for initiating injection Drug use?
3. What are the factors that influence injection Drug use among youth in district Okara?
4. How do youth perceive and experience the risks and consequences associated with injection Drug use?
5. How do youth perceive the impact of injection Drug use on their physical and mental health?

Assumptions

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1. Prevalence of injection drug abuse in urban areas are more common than rural areas
 2. Use of injection drug abuse among uneducated and unemployed youth are more.
 3. Male are more addicted of injection drug than female
 4. Injection Drug abuser ratio is low in okara district as compared to other substance abuse.
 5. Injection Drug abuse is one of the most challenging public health problem in okara.
 6. Injection Drug abuser face physical, mental, social and sexual issues.

Method

The paradigm of the study was interpretive, qualitative approach was used. The design of the study was phenomenology. The general population of interest to the study includes all injection drug abusing youth of district Okara Pakistan. Age between 18 to 35. Purposive snowball sampling technique was used, through which the researcher interviewed the specific people with personal experiences on the subject matter. The data collection procedure consisted of exploratory data collection in the form of semi-structured interviews with the 11 injection drug abusing male. The sample was collected from local streets of Okara, local cemetery of Okara, natural settings and recorded as well. All interviews were conducted by the researcher in Urdu and local language Punjabi; however, respondents were given the chance to express themselves in their local language if they wanted.

Study Design

- It is a qualitative research study.
- Semi-structured interviews were conducted by the researcher
- Snow ball sampling technique is used
- Data collected through Archival record (audio recording)



Population & Sample

- Youth of District Okara, Pakistan
- Injection Drug Abuser
- Age 18 to 35
- 11_participants

Procedure

With the topic of A phenomenological study of injection drug abuse among youth of Okara we start our research by making objectives and research questions. By making Methodology that we do interview of injection drug abuser and making our research a qualitative research to study injection drug abuser experience and explore the causes and risk factors of this addiction. Conducted interviews of injection drug abuser among ypuh of okara. A purposive sampling technique were used and through Archival record (audio) data collected. Next we use thematic analysis to write our findings and explain all the caueses risk factors and preventions and interventions in disscusion.



Instruments

- Interview guide consisted of 25 questions including demographic and probing questions.

Statistics

- **This is a qualitative research design and we used thematic analysis.**

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THANK
YOU